

Entry Level Gaming

The Seagate Barracuda ST1000DM003 (1TB) has nearly the same specs as the Toshiba 1 TB DT01ACA100 except that it has a 64 MB cache built into it and thus delivers better performance. It should only cost you about ₹300 more.

Mid-Range

We once again recommend the Seagate Barracuda ST1000DM003 (1TB) in this segment. We can be a little less frugal at the mid-range point so go ahead and pair it with a ZOTAC 120GB SSD to install your OS and whatever you want loading lightning fast.

High-end

The Western Digital WD20EZRZ 2 TB plus the Kingston UV300 SSD 240 GB combo should cost you about ₹8300. We're pretty sure you won't feel short of either space or speed with this combo.

Video-Editing / Gaming Glory

The Western Digital WD30EZRZ 3TB and Samsung 960 Pro 512GB SSD combo is suitable for very high speeds and good space.

Outrageous

The Western Digital WD40EFRX comes with 4 TB of space but you can always opt for more. As for the SSD, you can either go with a pair of the Samsung 960 Pro SSDs in RAID for some really outlandish speeds. RAID 0 benchmarks have produced read speeds of around 3,000 Mbps.

What to look for in the spec-sheet?

For HDDs, we've already established the fact that the two most important factors are the rotation speeds (mentioned in RPMs or Rounds Per Minute) and the seek-time. The higher the RPM, the faster the disk. The lower the seek-time, the faster it will operate when the disk is fragmented. In addition to these two important factors, you should also look at the power consumption by the disk in its idle and spinning states. Also, the more the number of physical disks inside the casing, the more power it will require to both start and stop operating. HDDs consume a high amount of power when they start up. The power consumption in the first second can reach up to about twice the power required for its normal operation (if you have read